Enhancing Operational Efficiency and Workload Management in SakhiBoutique – A Case Study of a Home-Based Tailoring Business

A Proposal report for the BDM capstone Project

Submitted by

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Declaration Statement

I am working on a Project titled **"Enhancing Operational Efficiency and Workload Management in Sakhi Boutique – A Case Study of a Home-Based Tailoring Business"**. I extend my appreciation to **Sakhi Boutique**, for providing the necessary resources that enabled me to conduct my project.

I hereby assert that the data presented and assessed in this project report is genuine and precise to the utmost extent of my knowledge and capabilities. The data has been gathered from primary sources and carefully analyzed to assure its reliability.

Additionally, I affirm that all procedures employed for the purpose of data collection and analysis have been duly explained in this report. The outcomes and inferences derived from the data are an accurate depiction of the findings acquired through thorough analytical procedures.

I am dedicated to adhering to the principles of academic honesty and integrity, and I am receptive to any additional examination or validation of the data contained in this project report.

I understand that the execution of this project is intended for individual completion and is not to be undertaken collectively. I thus affirm that I am not engaged in any form of collaboration with other individuals, and that all the work undertaken has been solely conducted by me. In the event that plagiarism is detected in the report at any stage of the project's completion, I am fully aware and prepared to accept disciplinary measures imposed by the relevant authority.

I understand that all recommendations made in this project report are within the context of the academic project taken up towards course fulfillment in the BS Degree Program offered by IIT Madras. The institution does not endorse any of the claims or comments.

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Date: 2 Oct 2025

1 Executive Summary

Sakhi Boutique is a small,home-based tailoring business located in Shreya Nagar, Osmanpura,Chh Sambhaji Nagar,Maharashtra. Founded by Mrs Rohini Mahagaonkar in year 2006, the boutique operates on B2C model and specializes in Maharashtrian wear such as Saree blouse,kurtis, Salwar suits, Traditional Frocks and dresses, Catering to women in the local community

The business currently faces challenges related to unstructured operations and irregular employee availability. manual record keeping for orders, customer measurements and payments results in limited visibility into income and workload distribution . During festive seasons, high demand combined with unpredictable staff attendance leads to delivery delays , increased stress and loss of potential customers

This project aims to enhance operational efficiency by introducing a semi-structured data recording system to record daily operations , monitor workloads, and track payments in an organized manner . the proposed approach will include identification of workflow bottlenecks ,studying demand variations and developing strategies for better workload distribution and scheduling .the expected outcome includes improved productivity, effective task management during peak seasons, and higher profitability supported by structured and data driven decision making

2 Organization Background

Sakhi Boutique is a home-based tailoring enterprise located in Chh Sambhajinagar , Maharashtra. Founded in 2006 by Mrs Rohini Pankaj Mahagaonkar , the boutique began as a small-scale operation from a spare room in her home , using a single sewing machine to serve family and neighbors. Rohini , who learned tailoring after her graduation transformed her hobby into a business over the next few years .In 2009,she formally established Sakhi Boutique ,expanding service to include customized wedding blouses , saree designs ,traditional dresses and other women's apparel for the local community .The boutique is recognized for its quality craftsmanship and personalized customer service

3 Problem Statement

3.1 Problem statement 1: Manual Tracking of orders and payments makes it difficult to know daily revenue and pending orders

3.2 Problem statement 2: unpredictable employee attendance causes delays in completing orders

3.3 Problem statement 2: high order volume during festive seasons to leads to uneven workload distribution

4 Background of the Problem

Sakhi Boutique is a Home-based tailoring business , operates in a semi-structured environment where most tasks such as order tracking , customer measurements , payments and employee scheduling are managed manually over time , this lack of systematism has led to inefficiencies in operations and reduced visibility into daily performance. The absence of centralized record keeping method makes it challenging to monitor completed and pending orders , track revenue accurately and assess workload distribution among employees

Internally, the boutique faces issues related to unorganized data management and irregular staff attendance , which directly affects order completion timelines . Employees often work on flexible schedules without proper task allocation , causing production delays during period of high demand .Externally , seasonal demand fluctuations , particularly during peak festival periods , place additional pressure on limited resources and amplify existing operational challenges

The major cause of these problems lies in the reliance on manual processes and the absence of structured operational data . without a proper system of recording and analyzing daily activities decision making becomes reactive rather than data driven. Implementing a semi structured data management system will help the boutique to streamline operations, balance workloads, and improve efficiency , ultimately leading to better time management and increased profitability.

5 Problem Solving Approach

To address the operational challenges faced by Sakhi boutique , a structured and data informed problem solving approach will be adopted . the focus will be on transforming manual operations into semi - digital processes that enable better decision-making , task allocation and performance tracking , the approach will follow four stages: Data collection, Data organization , analysis and Implementation.

5.1 Data Collection:

The first step involves collecting key operations data related to orders, payment , employee attendance and delivery timeline . This will be done using simple record sheets or digital spreadsheets . Each entry will include details such as order date , type of garments , delivery deadline , assigned tailor , payment statues and completion time. Collecting consistent data over a defined period of time will help in identifying recurring trends and problem areas

5.2 Data Organization:

Once Collected ,the data will be organized systematically in a semi-structured format. This may involve creating separate tables fro orders, customers, employees and payments .USing unique orderIDs will help link different dataset and ensure that information remains traceable.proper categorization will make it easier to compute daily revenue, pending orders and staff availability metrics.

5.3 Data Analysis:

Basic data analysis will be performed using spreadsheet simple visualization tools. Techniques such as calculating daily/weekly totals, identifying average order completion time and creating workload charts will reveal inefficiencies in the workflow. Attendance data can be correlated with delays to quantify the impact of absenteeism similarly, order volume analysis across different months can help to identify peak demand periods and resource requirements .these findings will support evidence based decision making and recommendation for workload management .

5.4 Implementation of Findings:

Based on the insights the boutique can introduce structured prices such as task scheduling charts, workloads rotation , and early demand forecasting for festive seasons . Additionally ,

maintaining a daily operation dashboard will provide visibility into ongoing orders and payments allowing for proactive decision making.

Through this data-driven approach, sakhi boutique can gradually shift from manual, intuition-based operations to more organized and measurable systems. The expected outcomes include improved workflow transparency, reduced order delays, and balanced staff workload. And better financial tracking . Overall this initiative will strengthen the boutique's operational foundation and create a scalable model for future growth.

6 Expected Timeline

6.1 Work Breakdown Structure:

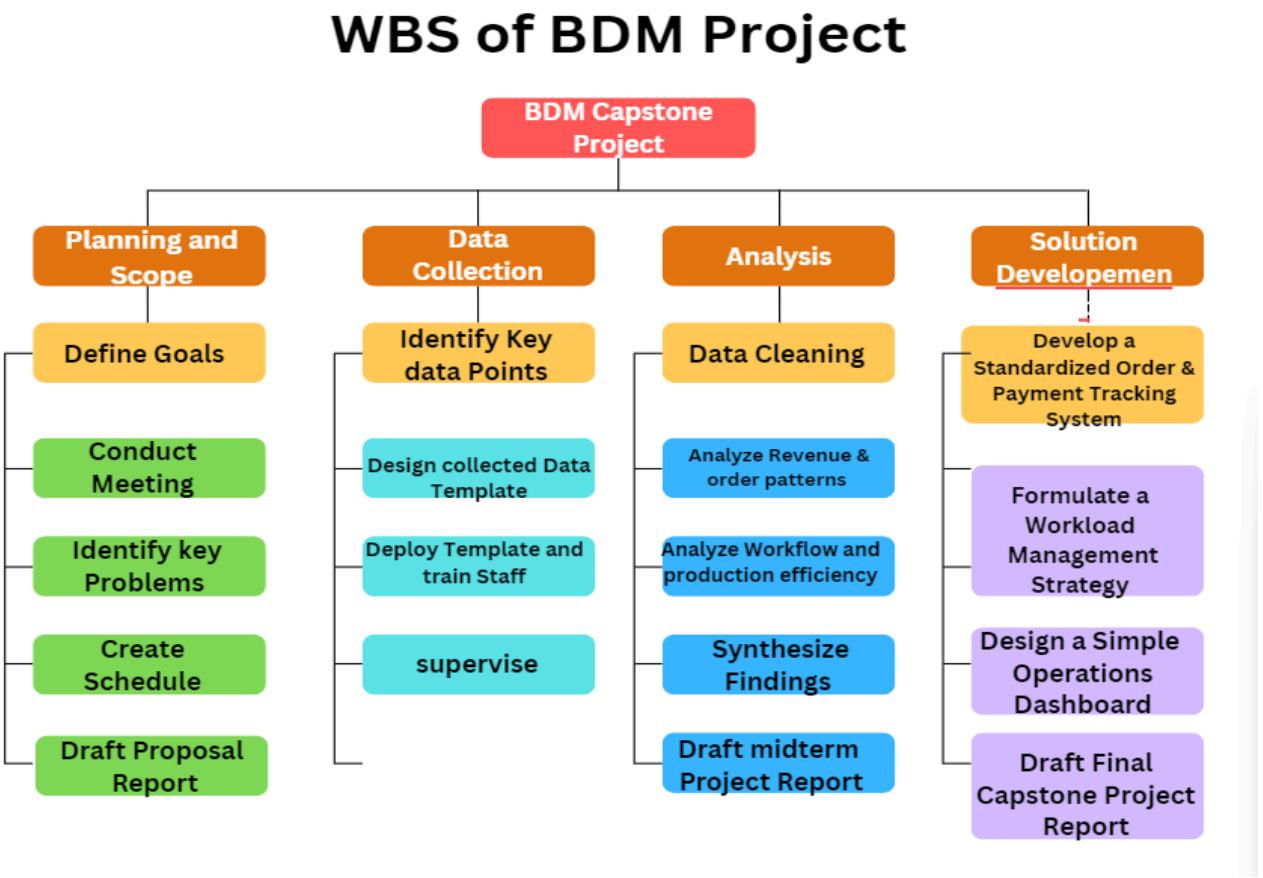

Fig 1 the Work Breakdown Structure of the Project

The project for Sakhi Boutique will be conducted over a period of approximately three months(September 2025 to December 2025). The implementation will follow a structured approach that begins with requirements gathering and communication with

boutique owners , followed by data collection, organization , analysis and proposal preparation . the final phase will include report writing and presentation of finding

6.2 Gantt chart

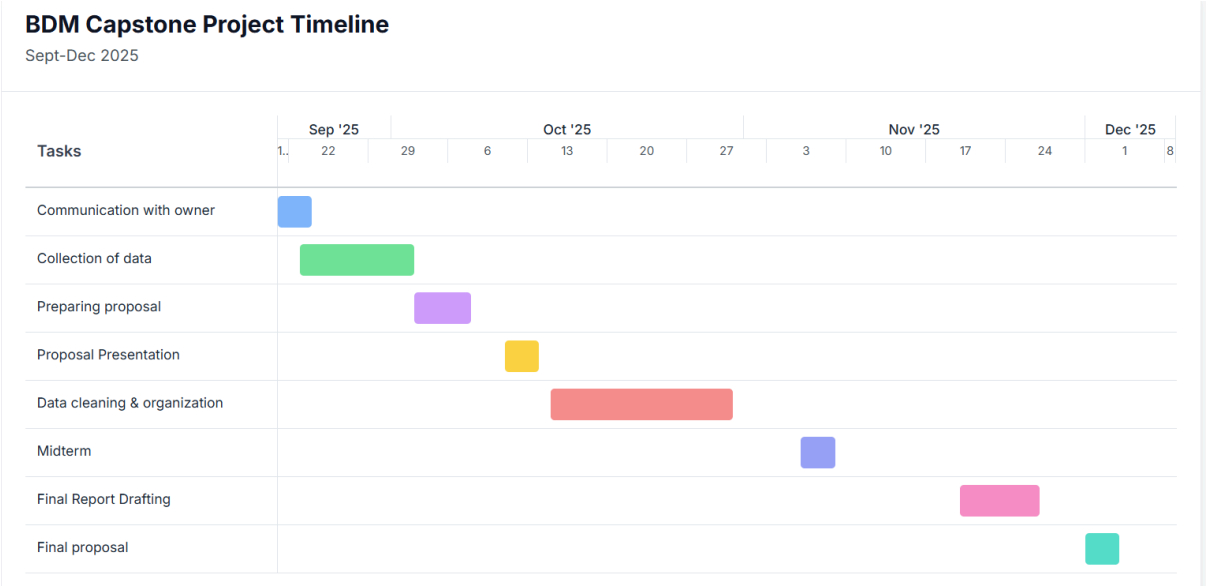

Figure 2 Expected timeline for completion of project.

7 Expected Outcome

The implementation of a semistructured data management system at Sakhi boutique is expected to deliver measurable improvements in daily operations and long term efficiency . The key expected outcomes are :

7.1 Improved operational visibility : Organized records of orders and workloads tracking will help provide a clear overview of daily performance and order status.

7.2 Reduction in Delivery delays by 20 - 25% : task scheduling and workloads tracking will balance employees assignments and ensure timely completion of orders

7.3 Better revenue tracking : structured payments records will allow for accurate monitoring of daily income and pending payments

7.4 Enhanced resource utilization: data on employees availability will enable better task allocation and reduce idle time during regular and peak seasons.

7.5 Increased customer satisfaction: Timely delivery, better communication and consistent service quality will enhance customer trust and retention .

Overall , these outcomes will contribute to improved productivity, efficient time management and data-driven decision making for sustainable business growth at sakhi boutique.